CEFR

VIETNAMESE V1-V6

Six levels. One clear learning journey.

V1 BEGINNER	**V2 ELEMENTARY**	**V3 INTERMEDIATE**
V4 UPPER INTERMEDIATE	**V5 ADVANCED**	**V6 PROFICIENT**

A visual guide to six Vietnamese proficiency levels.

INTRODUCTION

What is CEFR?

CEFR stands for the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages: Learning, teaching, assessment.

It is a framework of reference designed to provide a transparent, coherent and comprehensive basis for language syllabuses and curriculum guidelines, teaching and learning materials, and the assessment of foreign-language proficiency.



The CEFR describes foreign-language proficiency at six common reference levels: A1 and A2, B1 and B2, C1 and C2. It uses “can do” descriptors to define what a learner or language user can do at each level.

The framework is non-prescriptive: it is intended as a tool for reflection, communication and empowerment, supporting quality, coherence and transparency through a shared language and common proficiency scales.

Official reference
Council of Europe - Common European Framework of Reference for Languages
https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/introduction-and-context

THE SIX-LEVEL JOURNEY

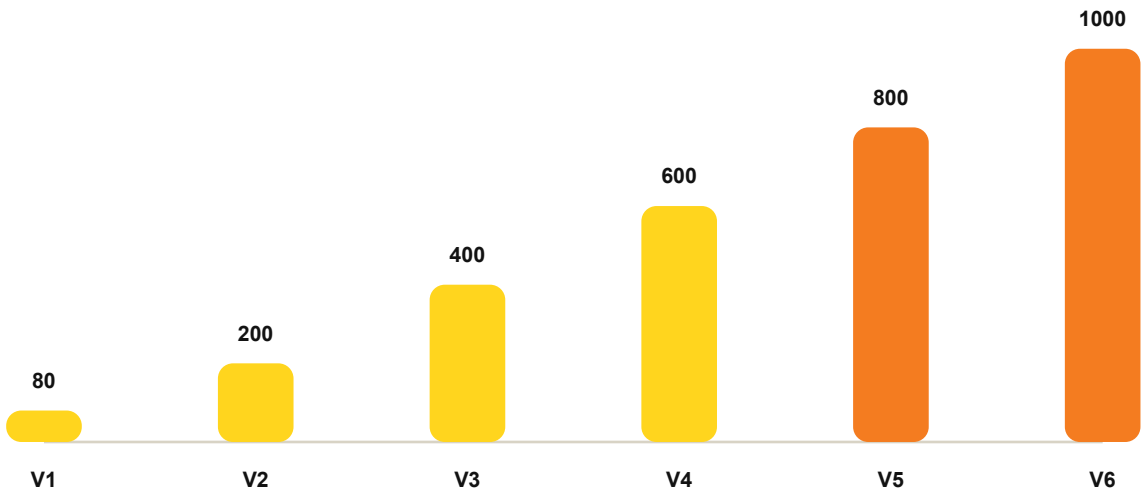
A progression from first interactions to full proficiency

V1	Beginner	80 hours cumulative instruction
V2	Elementary	200 hours cumulative instruction
V3	Intermediate	400 hours cumulative instruction
V4	Upper Intermediate	600 hours cumulative instruction
V5	Advanced	800 hours cumulative instruction
V6	Proficient	1000 hours cumulative instruction

The hours shown are cumulative and are reproduced from the supplied level descriptions.

CUMULATIVE INSTRUCTION

The learning path in hours



Cumulative instruction hours from the supplied level descriptions

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, the source pages state the cumulative instruction expectations shown above.

Beginner - Vietnamese V1

V1

80 hours
cumulative instruction

YOU CAN UNDERSTAND

- Very basic, everyday phrases.
- Carefully articulated, slow speech with long pauses.
- Very short and simple texts, familiar names and words.

WHAT YOU CAN DO WITH LEVEL V1 VIETNAMESE

A V1 level of Vietnamese would be sufficient for very simple interactions, for example as a tourist in Vietnam. A V1 level would not be sufficient for other academic or professional purposes.

- Can understand and use familiar everyday expressions and very basic phrases aimed at the satisfaction of concrete needs.
- Can introduce themselves or others; can ask and answer questions about personal details such as where they live, people they know, and things they have.
- Can interact with other people in a simple way provided the other person talks slowly, clearly, and is prepared to help.

Detailed Vietnamese skills

In order to evaluate the Vietnamese language proficiency of students as well as their own self-assessment, a V1 level learner should have the necessary Vietnamese skills to:

01 Introduce himself simply and use basic greetings.	07 Describe current weather conditions and suggest activities according to the weather forecast.
02 Tell where he and others are from and give a basic description of his city.	08 Talk in general terms about his health and describe common medical symptoms to a doctor.
03 Talk simply about family and colleagues, describing their appearance and personalities.	09 Describe the location of his home and give simple directions.
04 Discuss clothing at a basic level and ask sales clerks simple questions about it.	10 Talk about his hobbies and interests and make plans for fun activities with friends or colleagues.
05 Talk about favorite foods and make simple orders for take-out food.	11 Complete basic transactions at a hotel, including checking in and checking out.
06 Talk about daily activities and arrange meetings with friends and colleagues.	12 Discuss common products, make basic purchases and return faulty items.

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, students can expect to reach level V1 with 80 hours of cumulative instruction.

Elementary - Vietnamese V2

V2

200 hours
cumulative instruction

YOU CAN UNDERSTAND

- Very basic personal, family and job-related language.
- Enough to meet the needs with slow, clear speech.
- Short and simple texts from familiar topics.

WHAT YOU CAN DO WITH LEVEL V2 VIETNAMESE

A V2 level of Vietnamese is sufficient for tourism in Vietnam and socializing with Vietnamese speakers, although it is not adequate to develop deeper friendships. A V2 level of Vietnamese also allows for networking with Vietnamese-speaking colleagues, but is limited to very basic and simple topics.

A V2 level is neither sufficient enough for academic study, nor for consuming most Vietnamese-language media (TV, movies, radio, magazines, etc.).

- Can understand sentences and frequently used expressions related to areas of most relevance (e.g. very basic personal and family information, shopping, local geography, employment).
- Can communicate in normal day-to-day conversations requiring a simple and direct exchange of information on daily matters.
- Can describe aspects of his/her background in simple terms, such as living environment and matters in areas of immediate need.

Detailed Vietnamese skills

In order to evaluate the Vietnamese language proficiency of students as well as their own self-assessment, a V2 level learner should have the necessary Vietnamese skills to:

01 Evaluate coworkers' performance in the workplace.	08 Discuss clothing and what kind of clothes you like to wear.
02 Relate events from your past, including your weekend activities and interesting stories.	09 Engage in basic communication at work, including attending meetings on familiar topics.
03 Describe your past life, giving details about important milestones.	10 Describe an accident or injury, get medical help from a doctor and fill a prescription for medicine.
04 Entertain someone in your home or visit a friend or colleague in their home.	11 Engage in basic business socializing, welcoming guests and attending networking events.
05 Discuss your vacation plans and tell friends and colleagues about your vacation afterwards.	12 Understand and make basic business proposals in your area of expertise.
06 Talk about the natural world and travel to see animals and natural areas in your country.	13 Talk about and explain the rules of games.
07 Talk about movies that you like and choose a movie to see with friends.	

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, students can expect to reach level V2 with 200 hours of cumulative instruction.

Intermediate - Vietnamese V3

V3

400 hours
cumulative instruction

YOU CAN UNDERSTAND

- Main points on common topics at work, school, or traveling.
- General and specific details given clear speech.
- Factual texts on subjects of interest.

WHAT YOU CAN DO WITH LEVEL V3 VIETNAMESE

A V3 level of Vietnamese would be sufficient for interactions with Vietnamese speakers on familiar subject matter. In the workplace, people at a V3 level are able to read simple reports on common topics and write simple emails about subjects in their field. However, a V3 level is not adequate to fully function in Vietnamese in the workplace.

- Can clearly understand the main points of matters regularly encountered in work, school, leisure, etc.
- Can deal with most situations likely to arise whilst travelling in an area where the language is spoken.
- Can produce simple connected text on topics which are familiar or of personal interest.
- Can describe experiences, such as recent events, dreams, hopes and ambitions, and can briefly give reasons and explanations for actions, opinions and plans.

Detailed Vietnamese skills

In order to evaluate the Vietnamese language proficiency of students as well as their own self-assessment, a V3 level learner should have the necessary Vietnamese skills to:

01 Discuss your personal and professional hopes and dreams for the future.	07 Talk about relationships and dating, including meeting people through social media.
02 Arrange a job interview and interview for a job in your area of expertise.	08 Go to a restaurant, order food, engage in polite dinner conversation and pay for your food.
03 Talk about your television viewing habits and favorite programs.	09 Participate in negotiations in your area of expertise, if you have someone help you understand some difficult points.
04 Describe your education and your plans for future training.	10 Discuss workplace safety issues, report an injury and explain rules and regulations.
05 Talk about your favorite music, music trends, and plan a night out to listen to live music.	11 Discuss polite behavior and respond appropriately to impolite behavior.
06 Talk about maintaining a healthy lifestyle, give and get advice about healthy habits.	

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, students can expect to reach level V3 with 400 hours of cumulative instruction.

Upper Intermediate - Vietnamese V4

V4

600 hours
cumulative instruction

YOU CAN UNDERSTAND

- Main ideas of complex text.
- Standard spoken language, live or broadcast.
- Texts with a broad reading vocabulary and large degree of autonomy.

WHAT YOU CAN DO WITH LEVEL V4 VIETNAMESE

Many non-native Vietnamese speakers in international workplaces have this level of Vietnamese. A person working in Vietnamese at a V4 level will, however, lack certain nuances particularly outside his own field. He may also miss some of the subtleties and implied meanings in conversations.

- Can understand the main ideas of complex texts on both concrete and abstract topics, including technical discussions in his/her field of specialization.
- Can interact with a degree of fluency and spontaneity that makes regular interaction with native speakers quite easily, without strain for either party.
- Can produce clear and detailed text on a wide range of subjects, explain a viewpoint on a topical issue and provide advantages and disadvantages of various options.

Detailed Vietnamese skills

In order to evaluate the Vietnamese language proficiency of students as well as their own self-assessment, a V4 level learner should have the necessary Vietnamese skills to:

01 Participate in meetings in your area of expertise, with minimal help.

02 Discuss gender issues as they relate to perceptions of rudeness and cultural norms.

03 Talk about your personal finances and give advice to friends and colleagues about their finances.

04 Talk about your personal and professional lifestyle, including a description of your life at work.

05 Explain your education, experience, strengths and weaknesses, and discuss your career path.

06 Talk about mental processes and how you can use them to improve your effectiveness on the job.

07 Talk about what you like to read and make recommendations about good things to read.

08 Use appropriate language in social situations, including praising and expressing sympathy.

09 Discuss leadership qualities and talk about leaders whom you admire.

10 Deal with relatively complex awkward situations that arise in social and business contexts.

11 Discuss common political situations and the behavior of politicians.

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, students can expect to reach level V4 with 600 hours of cumulative instruction.

Advanced - Vietnamese V5

V5

800 hours
cumulative instruction

YOU CAN UNDERSTAND

- Longer texts and their implicit meaning.
- Lengthy speech on abstract topics with relative ease.
- Details in complex texts, even if unrelated to your own specialty.

WHAT YOU CAN DO WITH LEVEL V5 VIETNAMESE

A V5 level of Vietnamese allows for a full range of functionality at work or in an academic setting. The V5 level would allow for full autonomy in Vietnamese usage.

- Can understand a wide range of demanding, longer texts, and recognize underlying meaning.
- Can express ideas fluently and spontaneously without much searching for everyday expressions.
- Can use language flexibly and effectively for social, academic and professional purposes.
- Can produce clear, well-structured, detailed text on complex subjects, showing controlled use of Vietnamese organizational patterns, connectors and cohesive devices.

Detailed Vietnamese skills

In order to evaluate the Vietnamese language proficiency of students as well as their own self-assessment, a V5 level learner should have the necessary Vietnamese skills to:

01 Discuss in detail issues related to success, including building a motivated, successful team.	07 Compare and contrast various forms of education and individual schools.
02 Talk in some detail about your favorite paintings and the architecture of buildings that you like.	08 Discuss various types of humor, including subtle forms like sarcasm.
03 Discuss societal problems, possible solutions for problems and what role corporations can play.	09 Understand various communication styles, including direct & indirect, formal & informal.
04 Participate in discussions about conservation, sustainability and natural habitat protection.	10 Discuss issues related to your quality of life, including work-life balance and home living environment.
05 Talk about events and issues in the news and how they affect people and companies.	11 Understand and discuss issues related to ethics, like civil disobedience.
06 Talk about risks in life, including changing jobs and doing dangerous sports.	

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, students can expect to reach level V5 with 800 hours of cumulative instruction.

Proficient - Vietnamese V6

V6

1000 hours
cumulative instruction

YOU CAN UNDERSTAND

- Virtually anything heard or read with ease.
- All spoken Vietnamese at a fast native pace.
- Abstract, structurally complex text and literary writings.

WHAT YOU CAN DO WITH LEVEL V6 VIETNAMESE

A V6 level of Vietnamese is essentially equivalent to a Vietnamese native level. It allows for reading and writing of any type on any subject, nuanced expression of emotions and opinions, and active participation in any academic or professional setting.

- Can understand with ease virtually everything heard or read.
- Can summarize information from different spoken and written sources, reconstructing arguments and accounts in a coherent presentation.
- Can express him/herself spontaneously, very fluently and precisely, differentiating finer shades of meaning even in the most complex situations.

Detailed Vietnamese skills

In order to evaluate the Vietnamese language proficiency of students as well as their own self-assessment, a V6 level learner should have the necessary Vietnamese skills to:

01 Discuss issues related to science and technology, including robots and new inventions.	04 Discuss financial planning and give and understand advice about personal finance.
02 Talk about celebrities, celebrity activism and gossip about celebrities.	05 Talk about stress in your life and the lives of friends and colleagues.
03 Use a variety of techniques for promoting creativity in your speech and writing.	06 Discuss techniques for doing research on a wide range of topics.

Although progress will depend on each individual's ability and the type of course, students can expect to reach level V6 with 1000 hours of cumulative instruction.